Priyanka Pimple

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Education

PhD in Economics, University of Arkansas 2022 – 2027 (expected)
Committee: *Fayetteville, AR*

- *Chair*: Prof. Arya Gaduh, agaduh@walton.uark.edu
- Prof. Kyle Butts, kbutts@walton.uark.edu
- Prof. Michael Gechter, mgechter@walton.uark.edu

MA in Economics, Central University of Tamil Nadu 2018 – 2020
Thiruvarur, India

Bachelor of Commerce, Osmania University 2015 – 2018
Hyderabad, India

Working Papers

"Dams and Rural Labor Markets in India" *(Job Market Paper)*

Abstract: Large dams generate benefits across a wider region through irrigation and power, while their reservoirs submerge land in the villages that host them. This paper examines the labor-market adjustment of these host villages in India. I construct a new dataset that dates the first filling of 395 reservoirs from satellite surface-water records and link it to three rounds of village census data. Exploiting variation in distance to the shoreline among villages surrounding the same reservoir, I find that reservoir formation raises the agricultural wage labor share of the workforce by 2.9 percentage points within 2 kilometers of the water relative to villages 10 to 20 kilometers away, with no divergence in the preceding decade. The effect is concentrated in villages that lost land to the reservoir, is not accompanied by differential growth in irrigated area or non-farm employment, and dissipates within 7.5 kilometers. Work shifts within agriculture, toward the lowest-paid form of rural wage work, rather than out of it, and the adjustment is confined to a spatial scale at which conventional evaluations of dams would not detect it. Appraisals and compensation that account only for submerged land are therefore likely to understate the incidence of reservoir formation on the livelihoods of host villages. (Draft version)

"Balancing Motherhood and Employment: Analyzing the Consequences of Extended Maternity Leave in India"

Abstract: In 2017, India extended paid maternity leave from 12 to 26 weeks under the Maternity Benefit (Amendment) Act. The reform was meant to strengthen women's attachment to paid work, but by raising the cost of employing women of childbearing age it may also have reduced their employment. Using three rounds of the National Family Health Survey (2005–2021) and a difference-in-differences design, I estimate the effect of the extension on women's labor force participation. Participation among women of prime childbearing age fell by about 2.6 percentage points after the reform. The decline is largest among younger and more educated women, the groups most likely to hold the formal-sector jobs to which the law applies. The results suggest that employer financed mandates can narrow the very employment they are designed to protect. (Draft version)

"What Binds Women's Decision-Making?" *(Work in Progress)*

Publications

Pimple, Priyanka and Sumalatha, B. S. (2021). "Out-of-pocket Health Spending and Its Impact on Household Well-being in Maharashtra," Journal of Health Management. doi:10.1177/09720634211052412.

Research Experience

Asian Development Bank, Economic Research and Development Impact Department, Manila, Summer 2026.

Prof. Pradeep Racherla, Mahindra University, Hyderabad, August 2021 – January 2022.

Centre for Economic and Social Studies (CESS), Hyderabad, Summer 2019.

Teaching Experience

Principles of Macroeconomics, Instructor of Record, University of Arkansas, Fall 2024 – Spring 2027.

Basic Economics, Instructor of Record, University of Arkansas, Fall 2023, Spring 2024.

Conference Presentations and Workshops

Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development, ISI Delhi (scheduled) December 2026

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Houston (scheduled) November 2026

Asian Development Bank, Economics Brownbag Seminar Series, Manila August 2026

Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, Chicago March 2026

Honors and Awards

Dr. Yien-I Tu Endowed Scholarship, Sam M. Walton College of Business, 2026 – 2027

Adam Smith Fellowship, Mercatus Center, George Mason University, 2025 – 2026

Carl Menger Fellowship, Mercatus Center, George Mason University, 2024 – 2025

Doctoral Academy Fellowship, University of Arkansas, 2022 – 2026

Additional Information

Research fields: Development Economics, Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Gender Economics

Citizenship: India

Software: Stata (advanced), Python, QGIS, LaTeX

Languages: English, Hindi, Telugu, Tamil, Marathi, Kannada